
BEFORE THE IOWA BOARD OF SOCIAL WORK

Re:	)	CASE NO. 14-0108
Social Work Independent Level License of	)	
	)	
LAURA HEALLESS	)	COMBINED STATEMENT OF
License No. 05964	)	CHARGES, SETTLEMENT
Respondent.	)	AGREEMENT, AND FINAL ORDER

COMES NOW the Iowa Board of Social Work ("Board") and Laura Healless ("Respondent"), P.O. Box 71, Prairie City, Iowa 50228, and enter into this Combined Statement of Charges, Settlement Agreement, and Final Order ("Order") pursuant to Iowa Code sections 17A.10 and 272C.3(4) (2015), and 645 IAC 12, stating the following:

A. STATEMENT OF CHARGES

Count I

1. Respondent is charged with engaging in sexual activities or sexual contact with a former client's significant other, in violation of 645 IAC 282.2(9)"c", pursuant to Iowa Code section 147.55(9) and 645 IAC 283.2(12).

B. FACTUAL CIRCUMSTANCES

2. Respondent holds Iowa license #05964 to practice social work at the independent level. Respondent's license is currently inactive, having expired on December 31, 2014.

3. Respondent provided therapy to client #1 in 2013. In providing therapy services to client #1, Respondent became acquainted with client #1's significant other.

4. Respondent began a romantic relationship with client #1's significant other in the spring of 2014.

C. SETTLEMENT AGREEMENT AND FINAL ORDER

5. The Board has jurisdiction over the parties and the subject matter of these proceedings.

6. Respondent admits the allegations in the Statement of Charges and acknowledges that the allegations, if proven in a contested case hearing, would constitute grounds for the discipline agreed to in this Order.

7. Execution of this Order constitutes the resolution of a contested case. Respondent has a right to hearing before the Board on the charges, but Respondent waives the right to hearing and all attendant rights, including the right to appeal or seek judicial review of the Board's action, by freely and voluntarily entering into this Order. Once entered, this Order shall have the force and effect of a disciplinary order entered following a contested case hearing.

8. Respondent acknowledges that she has the right to be represented by counsel on this matter.

9. Respondent agrees that the State's counsel may present this Order to the Board and may have *ex parte* communications with the Board while presenting it.

10. This Order is subject to approval by a majority of the full Board. If the Board does not approve this Order, it shall be of no force or effect to either party, and shall not be admissible for any purpose in further proceedings in this matter. If the Board approves this Order, it shall be the full and final resolution of this matter.

11. This Order shall be part of Respondent's permanent record and shall be considered by the Board in determining the nature and severity of any disciplinary action to be imposed in the event of any future violations.

12. This Order shall not be binding as to any new complaints received by the Board.

13. Respondent understands the Board is required by federal law to report any adverse action to the National Practitioner Data Bank.

14. This Order, when fully executed, is a public record and is available for inspection and copying in accordance with the requirements of Iowa Code chapters 22 and 272C.

15. The Board's approval of this Order shall constitute a **FINAL ORDER** of the Board.

IT IS THEREFORE ORDERED:

16. Respondent agrees to **VOLUNTARILY SURRENDER** her license to practice as a social worker to resolve this matter. Respondent shall surrender her social worker license to the Board immediately.

17. This voluntary surrender, when accepted by the Board, has the same force and effect as an order of revocation under 645 IAC 12.1(5).

18. Respondent agrees not to use any words or titles which imply or represent that she is a licensed social worker, or to otherwise hold herself out to the public as a licensed social worker, or to engage in the practice of social work for which a license is required in the State of Iowa.

19. Respondent may not request reinstatement for at least one year from the date of this Order. Prior to seeking reinstatement, Respondent must undergo a comprehensive mental health and boundaries evaluation with a Board-approved evaluator. Respondent shall ensure the evaluator has the entire investigative file prior to the evaluation. The evaluation must address Respondent's ability to safely practice as a licensed social worker. Respondent may request reinstatement by filing an application for reinstatement under 645 IAC 11.31 and 280.15. Respondent's license shall not be reinstated except upon a showing by Respondent that the basis for revocation of her license no longer exists, and that it is in the public interest for the license to be reinstated.

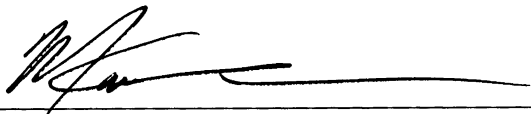
20. Should Respondent violate the terms of this Order, the Board may initiate action to impose other licensee discipline as authorized by Iowa Code chapters 147, 154C, and 272C and 645 IAC 13 and 283.

This Combined Statement of Charges, Settlement Agreement, and Final Order is voluntarily submitted by Respondent to the Board for its consideration on the 21 day of September, 2015.



LAURA HEALLESS
Respondent

This Combined Statement of Charges, Settlement Agreement, and Final Order is approved by the Iowa Board of Social Work on the 9 day of November, 2015.



Chairperson
Iowa Board of Social Work

Copy to:

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